Lesson 1 — A Day with a Phone

Level: A1+ (entry) → first step toward A2

Theme: Daily routine and basic IT

Time: 6 short sessions, 40–50 minutes each

Skills: Listening → Reading → Vocabulary → Grammar → Comprehension → Speaking → Writing

New in this lesson: present simple, time expressions (at six o'clock, every morning, in the evening), and the five core TOEFL question types

01 · Passage — Sami's Morning

> How to do the listening. The student listens before seeing the text, twice, then reads. Options: (1) you read the passage aloud slowly, about 90 words per minute, with a short pause at every full stop; (2) paste the passage into any free text-to-speech tool and set the speed to 0.8×. Rule for Lesson 1: no reading during the first two listenings.

1.1 Before listening (2 minutes, speak in Arabic if needed)

1. What is the first thing you do in the morning?
2. Do you use a phone or a computer every day?
3. What makes studying difficult in your area?

1.4 Now read the passage

📖 Passage: Sami's Morning (185 words)

Sami lives in a small flat with his family. He is twenty years old. Every morning he wakes up at six o'clock. The first thing he does is look at his phone.

On his phone, Sami checks the weather and reads messages from his friends. Then he eats breakfast with his mother and his sister. They drink tea and eat bread, cheese and olives.

At seven o'clock, Sami goes to the computer centre near his house. He studies computers there. He learns how to use email, how to write documents, and how to keep his files safe. His teacher says, "A computer is only a tool. The important thing is the person who uses it."

Sami likes his class, but the internet is often slow. Sometimes the electricity stops and the computers turn off. Then the students talk and practise on paper until the power comes back.

In the evening, Sami helps his sister with her homework. Before he sleeps, he puts his phone on the table and charges it for the next day.

1.5 Read aloud

Read the passage aloud once. Record it on the phone. Keep the recording — we will compare it with Lesson 4.

02 · Listening questions

1.2 Listening task — first time (eyes closed, no text)

Listen and answer with one word or a short phrase:

L1. How old is the person in the story?

L2. What does he study?

L3. Is the story about the morning, the evening, or both?

1.3 Listening task — second time

Write down three words you heard and understood. Write down one word you heard but did not understand.

03 · Vocabulary

2.1 Key words

#	WORD	TYPE	SIMPLE MEANING	ARABIC	EXAMPLE
1	flat	noun	a home inside a building	شقة	They live in a small flat.
2	wake up	verb	stop sleeping	يستيقظ	I wake up at six.
3	check	verb	look at something to get information	يتفقّد	He checks the weather.
4	breakfast	noun	the first meal of the day	الفطور	We eat breakfast together.
5	centre	noun	a place where people meet, learn or work	مركز	A computer centre.
6	document	noun	a file with writing in it	مستند	He writes a document.
7	safe	adj.	not in danger; protected	آمن	Keep your files safe.
8	tool	noun	a thing you use to do work	أداة	A computer is a tool.
9	slow	adj.	not fast	بطيء	The internet is slow.
10	electricity	noun	the power that makes machines work	الكهرباء	The electricity stops.
11	practise	verb	do something many times to learn it	يتدرّب	They practise on paper.
12	charge	verb	put electricity into a battery	يشحن	He charges his phone.

2.2 Synonyms and opposites

WORD	SYNONYM (SAME MEANING)	OPPOSITE
slow	not quick	fast
safe	protected	dangerous / in danger
small	little	big / large
difficult	hard	easy
wake up	get up	go to sleep
stop	finish	start / continue
near	close to	far from
help	assist	ignore

2.3 Expressions to learn

EXPRESSION	WHAT IT REALLY MEANS
wake up	stop sleeping
turn off	stop working / stop the power (computers turn off)
come back	return (the power comes back = the electricity returns)
check the weather	look to see if it is hot, cold or rainy
keep your files safe	protect your files so you do not lose them
only a tool	it is just a thing — the person is more important
the first thing he does	the action before all other actions

2.4 Vocabulary practice

A. Write the opposite:

1. fast → _____
2. big → _____
3. easy → _____
4. dangerous → _____
5. far from → _____

B. Which word is different? Circle it and say why:

1. breakfast — tea — bread — document
2. phone — computer — olives — email
3. slow — fast — quick — safe

04 · Grammar — the present simple

Lesson 1 has no tense to come back to yet — this is where the course starts. Everything below is already in the passage you have read.

3.1 One shape, one change

Every sentence about now, every day or always uses the same shape. Only he, she and it change it, by adding -s.

PERSON	VERB
I / you / we / they	wake up, eat, study
he / she / it	wakes up, eats, studies

3.2 Straight from the passage

FROM THE PASSAGE	WHY
Sami lives in a small flat.	he → lives
He wakes up at six o'clock.	he → wakes
They drink tea.	they → drink
The students talk and practise.	they → talk
The internet is often slow.	it → is

3.3 The time words that go with it

> every morning · every day · at six o'clock · in the evening · sometimes · often · always · before he sleeps

When you see one of these, the verb takes this shape. They are the signal.

3.4 Negative and question

	FORM	EXAMPLE
Negative	do not / does not + the plain verb	He does not use a computer at home.
Question	Do / Does + person + the plain verb	Does he study computers?

Note the plain verb after does: does he study, never does he studies.

3.5 Grammar practice

A. Write the verb in the right shape:

1. Sami _____ (live) in a small flat.

2. He _____ (wake up) at six o'clock.
3. They _____ (eat) bread and cheese.
4. The internet _____ (be) often slow.
5. The students _____ (practise) on paper.
6. Sami _____ (help) his sister.

B. Make it negative:

1. He uses a computer at home. → _____
2. They drink coffee. → _____

C. Make it a question:

1. He studies computers. → _____
2. They eat breakfast together. → _____

05 · Comprehension — TOEFL question types

Part A — Multiple choice (choose ONE answer)

1. (Factual) What does Sami do first in the morning?

   A. He eats breakfast.
   B. He looks at his phone.
   C. He goes to the computer centre.
   D. He helps his sister.

2. (Factual) What do Sami and his family eat for breakfast?

   A. Bread, cheese and olives
   B. Rice and chicken
   C. Only tea
   D. The passage does not say

3. (Negative factual) According to the passage, Sami learns all of the following EXCEPT

   A. how to use email
   B. how to write documents
   C. how to repair computers
   D. how to keep his files safe

4. (Vocabulary in context) The word "slow" in the passage is closest in meaning to

   A. not working
   B. not fast
   C. very expensive
   D. very new

5. (Reference) In the sentence "The important thing is the person who uses it", the word "it" refers to

   A. the teacher
   B. the class
   C. the computer
   D. the file

6. (Inference) It can be inferred from the passage that

   A. Sami does not like studying computers
   B. the students stop learning when the electricity stops
   C. the students continue learning even without computers
   D. Sami has his own computer at home

Part C — Fill in the blanks

Use these words. There are two extra words you will not need.

> charges · slow · tea · safe · tool · electricity · difficult · homework · centre

1. Sami goes to a computer _____ near his house.
2. He learns how to keep his files _____.
3. His teacher says a computer is only a _____.
4. The internet in the class is often _____.
5. Sometimes the _____ stops.
6. In the evening, Sami helps his sister with her _____.
7. Before he sleeps, he _____ his phone.

06 · True / false

Part B — True / False

Write T or F. If it is False, write the correct sentence.

1. Sami wakes up at seven o'clock. ____
2. Sami lives alone. ____
3. The computer centre is near his house. ____
4. The internet is always fast. ____
5. The students use paper when the computers turn off. ____
6. Sami charges his phone in the morning. ____

07 · Speaking

4.1 Speaking (record each answer on the phone, 30–45 seconds)

1. Describe your morning. Use wake up, breakfast, then, after that.
2. What do you use your phone for? Give two things.
3. Is a computer important for your study? Why?

Useful sentence starters:

I wake up at ____ o'clock.

The first thing I do is ____.

After that, I ____.

I use my phone to ____.

I think a computer is important because ____.

08 · Writing — My Morning

4.2 Writing — "My Morning" (6–8 sentences)

Model answer (copy the shape, change the words):

> I wake up at seven o'clock. The first thing I do is drink water. Then I eat breakfast with my family. We eat bread and cheese. After breakfast, I study English for one hour. I use my phone to read messages. In the evening, I charge my phone.

Checklist before you send it:

- [ ] Every sentence starts with a capital letter.
- [ ] Every sentence ends with a full stop (.)
- [ ] I used I wake up, not I wakes up.
- [ ] I used at least 4 new words from Session 2.
- [ ] My text has 6–8 sentences.

09 · Review

5.1 Listen again (no text) and answer

1. Name three things Sami does with his phone.
2. Why do the students work on paper?

5.2 Mini-quiz (10 marks)

1. The opposite of fast is _____.
2. The opposite of safe is _____.
3. To stop sleeping = to ____ ____.
4. To put electricity in a battery = to _____.
5. A thing you use to do work = a _____.
6. A file with writing in it = a _____.
7. Write a sentence with check.
8. Write a sentence with practise.
9. Write a sentence with electricity.
10. Say the passage title and one sentence about it, from memory.

5.3 Lesson 1 self-report (send to the teacher)

QUESTION	ANSWER
Minutes studied this week	
Hardest part (listening / reading / vocabulary / speaking / writing)	
New words I can now use without looking	
One thing I want to repeat next week	

10 · Answer key and teacher notes

Listening: L1 — twenty years old · L2 — computers · L3 — both (morning and evening)

Part A (MCQ): 1-B · 2-A · 3-C · 4-B · 5-C · 6-C

Part B (True/False):

1. F — He wakes up at six o'clock.
2. F — He lives with his family.
3. T
4. F — The internet is often slow.
5. T
6. F — He charges it before he sleeps / in the evening.

Part C (Fill in the blanks): 1. centre · 2. safe · 3. tool · 4. slow · 5. electricity · 6. homework · 7. charges (Extra words: tea, difficult)

2.4 A (Opposites): 1. slow · 2. small / little · 3. difficult / hard · 4. safe · 5. near / close to

2.4 B (Odd one out): 1. document (the others are food/drink) · 2. olives (the others are technology) · 3. safe (the others describe speed)

3.5 A (Present simple): 1. lives · 2. wakes up · 3. eat · 4. is · 5. practise · 6. helps 3.5 B (Negative): 1. He does not use a computer at home. · 2. They do not drink coffee. 3.5 C (Question): 1. Does he study computers? · 2. Do they eat breakfast together?

Mini-quiz: 1. slow · 2. dangerous · 3. wake up · 4. charge · 5. tool · 6. document · 7–10. teacher judgement

Teacher Notes

Why this order. Listening before reading stops the student from "reading with the ears" — at A1 the habit of matching sound to text too early blocks real listening later. From Lesson 3 we can shorten the gap.

What Lesson 1 deliberately does NOT do. No past tense, no abstract vocabulary, no long sentences. The passage uses only present simple and about 120 distinct words, most of them in the first 500 most-frequent English words. The present simple in part 04 is shown as a pattern taken from the passage, not as a rule to memorise; it is the first turn of the grammar spiral, and Lesson 2 comes back to it.

Success criteria for Lesson 1. The student should be able to:

- answer the three listening questions correctly on the second hearing;
- read the passage aloud in under 2 minutes without stopping;
- use 8 of the 12 key words in their own sentence;
- write 6 correct simple sentences about their own morning.

If it is too easy: move to Lesson 2 with a 250-word passage, add past simple, and add a 2-question summary task. If it is too hard: split the passage into two halves across two weeks and cut the vocabulary list to 8 words.

Toward B2. The TOEFL question types in Part A (factual, negative factual, vocabulary in context, reference, inference) are the same five types the student will meet at B2 level. We keep the types constant for 8 months and raise only the text difficulty — so the exam format never becomes the obstacle.